Voting power has become more concentrated among DReps since the role was established. What do you think most contributes to this change?

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Does Delegators to retired Dreps still give rewards?

Yes

Concentration is the natural result of incentives, visibility and friction. A handful of DReps are loud, always in threads, spaces and have thousands of delegators. That feels like proof enough for most people, yes/no matter how good you are if nobody knows you they were delegator to you.

Advocating for ADA holders' self-voting scenarios would help with power centralisation — probably would affect participation.

Influencer effect

5) Not enough places to discover DReps. Only the staking platform where the dreps market place is hosted is recommended in a number of 1-clicks

Historical rights and knowledge is the most influential factor for delegation concentration.

simple shortcut when faced with complexity is to delegate to people they know

Metrics (M4/M5-A-S)

Voting power concentration (Gini coefficient, Nakamoto coefficient)

Decentralization requires not only participation, but also balanced distribution of influence and transparent representation. Evaluate whether delegated voting power is broadly distributed, whether the representative layer remains active, and whether governance decisions are accompanied by publicly accessible rationales. Together, these metrics assess whether Cardano's representative governance avoids concentration of power and operates in alignment with the decentralization and transparency principles articulated in CIP-1694 and the Cardano Constitution

What changes do you think would help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps?

There is no incentive / control mechanism for DRep voting power. We NEED some sort of k param / power cap if we truly want to encourage spread of power (decentralisation)

The k we use for SPOs is a soft-cap tied to rewards. Currently dReps earn no rewards

using the governance action deposit address to gamify incentives

Taxing people for the idea might discourage creativity and forces people to convene first

True that. The focus for DReps would be limiting of power gained for voting, 'some sort of k param ?'

If compensation comes from treasury, then all ADA holders are taxed

If compensation comes from proposer fee, then the proposers who create the work are the only ones who pay the tax

Don't tax ideas. Other structures like prediction markets could be a possible alternative model to incentivize DReps to engage

The cost of staking rewards lost for tying up 100k ADA deposit for 6 epochs is about ~200-300 ADA.

User experience of DRep onboarding is centered through a few apps that self promote their power

comparing dreps is difficult

we would need simpler dashboards and tools that help to convey a message and goal of actions and rationale

7) the wallet UX is very incompatible with the governance needs

8) Wallets are doing minimal marketing of themselves and their governance, so the behavior of delegation is not active but passive by Dreps

Wallet rankings /defaults

Wallet UIs -It is harder for users to find DReps, compare for example, how SPO UIs are much more searchable/display more info

Some ada owners have less time to evaluate their own DReps than to even evaluate others to shift delegation duty

6) Wallets are how they handle initial delegations. Some alert users to delegate, one major wallet quietly delegates to always_abstain with zero notifications

Wallets and how they handle initial delegations. Some alert users to delegate, one major wallet quietly delegates to always_abstain with zero notifications

6) The ada owners don't know how their dreps have voted unless they actively search for it or are looking at it.

sticky delegate, delegate to who you know and forget about it until something breaks

lottery mechanism could also help

Requirement to select a dRep to withdraw staking rewards leads to choosing wallet default

5) The ada is not used that much (rare, or with pressure), or any other such behaviour that lack of ada holders to use dreps as a tool to earn passive rewards.

only social incentives for delegators may not be enough or often times unnoticed

1) Not enough resources to check the drep mindset which aligns with the ada owner

4) The effect of a drep's actions (voting) is not immediately seen or ada holder sees it only by the time the voting is already over and anticipated.

Some ada owners don't know how to access or read gov. files which makes it difficult for them to access DRep participation

GitHub rationales or other governance material is not clear to read and makes scaffolding not related to Cardano Governance

Top 4 DReps by count (not stake) are wallet DReps, always_abstain or always_no_confidence and is worth more investigation

there is large information gap between what governance is and what general drep delegator knows

and sometimes also on the understanding how does the governance system will when Cardano Governance